



MARA VELDKAMP

Lead Data Scientist

Lead · Amsterdam, Netherlands
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PROFILE

Lead Data Scientist with 10+ years of experience turning ambiguous product and commercial questions into measurable, privacy-conscious data solutions. Specialises in experimentation platforms, product analytics and data governance, partnering with product, engineering, legal and leadership teams to improve decision quality without compromising user trust.

CORE SKILLS

Experiment design and causal inference · A/B testing platforms · Product analytics · Python, SQL and R · Metric and KPI frameworks · Data governance and privacy · dbt and modern data stacks · Stakeholder leadership · Machine learning

EXPERIENCE

Northstar Commerce | Lead Data Scientist

04/2022 - Present

- Led a six-person analytics group building an experimentation platform used by 18 product teams, with standardised guardrails for sample-ratio mismatch, novelty effects and exposure logging.
- Introduced a governed product-metrics layer and decision templates, shortening experiment readouts from several days to one day while making assumptions and limitations explicit.
- Partnered with privacy and engineering to replace sensitive event attributes with purpose-limited identifiers and retention rules across customer analytics.

Tech: Python, SQL, Snowflake, dbt, Airflow, Looker

Mosaic Mobility | Senior Product Data Scientist

02/2019 - 03/2022

- Designed the company's first centralised A/B testing workflow, including power analysis, automated quality checks and reproducible analysis notebooks.
- Established activation, retention and marketplace-health metrics used in quarterly planning; helped product teams distinguish correlation from causal impact in roadmap decisions.
- Built privacy reviews into the analytics delivery process and documented data ownership, lineage and approved use cases for more than 200 tracked events.

Tech: Python, R, SQL, BigQuery, Google Analytics 4, Tableau

Brightline Digital | Data Scientist

07/2016 - 01/2019

- Analysed customer journeys and support data to identify onboarding friction, informing a redesigned first-session experience.
- Created forecasting and segmentation models for marketing and product teams, with clear validation reports and monitoring guidance.

Tech: Python, R, SQL, PostgreSQL, scikit-learn

EDUCATION

University of Amsterdam

MSc, Business Analytics · 2014-2016

Erasmus University Rotterdam

BSc, Econometrics and Operations Research · 2011-2014

LANGUAGES

Dutch: native · English: C2 · German: B1